गृह मंत्रालय
MINISTRY OF
HOME AFFAIRS
सत्यमेव जयते

Indian
Cyber
Crime
Coordination
Centre

CYBER DIGEST

PREPARED BY
INDIAN CYBER CRIME COORDINATION CENTRE

MINISTRY OF HOME AFFAIRS

7th February 2024

FOR MORE INFO

Helpline 1930 WWW.CYBERCRIME.GOV.IN *Follow: @cyberdost*

National

S. No.	News	Source
1.	3.2 lakh SIM cards involved in frauds blocked by government	The Hindu
2.	You can check if a mobile number or upi id is involved in cyber frauds; Database in the works by MHA's I4C	News18
3.	Scamsters are increasingly creating fake profiles of government officials, well known figures to target public: T.N. police	The Hindu
4.	What is mobile threat defense; know how to protect your mobile from cyber threats	Times of India
5.	Telangana State Cyber Security Bureau Warns of Lucky Draw Scams	ETV Bharat
6.	Karnataka Govt inks MoU with Truecaller for cyber security	Indian Express
7.	Bengaluru techie loses Rs 96 lakh in stock market fraud, FIR registered	News Nine
8.	Delhi police nabs mastermind of Rs 58 lakh virtual credit card scam	BNN Breaking
9.	बैंक KYC के नाम पर चल रहा है धोखाधड़ी का खेल, RBI ने बताया बचने का शानदार तरीका	Money Control

International

S. No.	News	Source
1.	Schneider Electric Confirms Data Leak From a Ransomware Attack	CPO Magazine
2.	HPE is investigating claims of a new security breach	Security Affairs

National

3.2 lakh SIM cards involved in frauds blocked by govt

The Centre informed the Lok Sabha on Tuesday that more than 3.2 lakhs SIM cards and 49,000 IMEIs as reported by the police have been blocked by the Government of India.

Minister of State for Home Ajay Kumar Mishra was replying to a question whether the Government has taken any steps to curb the menace of illegal websites which promote investment and other types of scams.

According to details provided in the written reply, the Citizen Financial Cyber Fraud Reporting and Management System' under Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre (I4C) received around 11.28 lakh complaints of cyber frauds from 36 States in the year 2023. The total amount of financial fraud reported through these complaints came to about Rs 921.59 crores, the reply stated.

The maximum complaints were reported from Uttar Pradesh-1,97,546 complaints, Maharashtra-1,25,153 complaints and Gujarat-1,21,701 complaints.

The system has been launched for immediate reporting of financial frauds and to stop siphoning off of funds by fraudsters. Since inception, more than Rs. 1200 crore have been saved which were linked to more than 4.7 lakh complaints. A toll-free Helpline number '1930' has also been operationalised to get assistance in lodging online cyber complaints.

The 'National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal' (https://cybercrime.gov.in) has been launched, as a part of I4C, to enable the public to report cybercrimes, with special focus on cybercrimes against women and children. Cybercrime incidents reported on this portal, their conversion into FIRs and subsequent action thereon are handled by the State/UT Law Enforcement Agencies concerned, the reply said.

Soon, You Can Check if a Mobile Number or UPI ID is Involved in Cyber Frauds; Database in the Works by MHA's I4C

The Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) is compiling and integrating a comprehensive database encompassing URLs, phone numbers, Telegram contacts, and email IDs from websites associated with cyber frauds, specifically phishing and smishing, News18 has learnt.

A high-ranking official told News18 that this data is pivotal in combating cybercrime as it paves the way for the establishment of a depository. This depository is anticipated to aid both the public and law enforcement agencies in identifying and addressing cyber threats.

Under the proposed plan, individuals will have the capability to verify the legitimacy of any contact, URL, or email ID by utilising the I4C website. When reporting a cybercrime, individuals can now complete a form detailing information such as the website, phone number, bank account number, UPI ID, and social media accounts involved in the fraudulent activity.

The citizen-provided information is then incorporated into a depository. Another feature allows users to input a mobile number, website, UPI ID etc. to ascertain if they are associated with any cybercrime. This will help citizens check instantly if any number or account is involved in cyber frauds.

Asked about concerns of potential misuse of the data, an official emphasised that the data is backed by multiple complaints, not isolated incidents. Additionally, provisions are in place to address instances where false details are intentionally provided, allowing individuals to file requests if they believe someone has maliciously submitted incorrect information.

The Integrated Cybercrime Coordination Center (I4C) clarifies that it does not certify the authenticity of complaints under investigation by local police authorities. Users who disagree with specific identifiers on the database can send an email to address discrepancies.

The number of complaints have increased at least 500% from close to 2.57 lakh in 2020 to 15.56 lakh in 2023. The MHA data also revealed that states like Haryana, Telangana,

Uttarakhand, Gujarat and Goa top in reporting cybercrime complaints, while Chandigarh reported the highest number of cases among Union Territories.

The data given by the MHA says around 50,000 citizens facing financial frauds in India are being assisted. Around 4.3 lakh victims saved Rs 11.27 crore with the help of I4C, an increase of almost 800%.

Scamsters are increasingly creating fake profiles of government officials, well known figures to target public: T.N. police

Recently, the relative of a top police officer in Tamil Nadu received a WhatsApp call from the officer. It had been many days since the two had spoken, and so initially, the relative did not realise something was wrong -- the WhatsApp profile even had the correct photograph, making it seem genuine. After a few enquiries however, the caller asked the relative to transfer some money, which he said was for charity purposes, to a bank account. The account however, did not belong to the police officer. Suspicious, the relative called the officer, and only then did he realise that he had nearly fallen victim to a scam.

Scamsters have called relatives and friends of two T.N. District Collectors in similar cases. Even the Chief Electoral officer has not been spared.

The Cyber Crime Wing of the T.N. Police say cyber criminals are adopting increasingly sophisticated tactics to exploit unsuspecting individuals. This is one such alarming trend that has been on the rise: the creation of fake profiles impersonating senior government officials or celebrities to deceive and manipulate people into parting with their money.

These scams often commence with cyber criminals collecting information about the individuals through their social media accounts or other online spaces where individuals share personal information. Additional Director of Police, Cyber Crime Wing Sanjay Kumar said, “Using the information collected, they meticulously craft fake profiles on social media platforms such as Facebook, X and WhatsApp, mirroring the identities of trusted figures, such as senior officers, CEOs, or government officials. The perpetrators then exploit the credibility of these

personas to establish trust with potential victims."

Victims receive messages through social media platforms, urgently seeking financial aid for various reasons – emergency medical expenses, unexpected legal trouble or fabricated philanthropic initiatives. The conmen employ psychological tactics to heighten the sense of urgency, playing on the victim's emotions and the trust they repose in the well known figures.

Police said in all, 1,376 complaints about fake profiles scams have been registered in Tamil Nadu through the National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal over the past six months.

Mr. Kumar advises people to always cross-verify any unusual requests directly with the person involved and regularly update passwords and enable two-factor authentication. He also advises all users to review their privacy setting on social media platforms to minimise the risk of unauthorised access.

Members of the public can report any such scams by dialing the Cyber Crime toll-free Helpline 1930 or logging on to www.cybercrime.gov.in

What is Mobile Threat Defense; know how to protect your mobile from cyber threats

Mobiles have become widely used, allowing users to combine personal and professional activities on a single portable device. However, these also come with significant risks. Organisations are now turning to mobile threat defence (MTD) to protect the smartphones and tablets of their mobile workforce from cyber threats that can compromise data. In this article, we will discuss what MTD entails, the types of threats faced, and effective defence strategies.

The increasing complexity of threats to mobile devices poses a significant concern. As mobile devices play a crucial role in both personal and professional lives, they have become attractive targets for cybercriminals. Bring Your Own Device (BYOD) policies have further amplified these risks, exposing corporate networks to various mobile-specific threats.

As technology advances and user behaviour changes, new threats emerge. Attackers are quick to exploit vulnerabilities, making it essential to stay ahead of the curve.

Most Common Types of Mobile Device Threats

- **Phishing attacks:** These deceptive tactics often come in the form of links or attachments in emails, texts, or social media messages, aiming to

deceive users into disclosing sensitive information.

- **Malware:** This malicious software is crafted to harm, disrupt, or illicitly access a device without authorization.
- **Ransomware:** A specific type of malware that locks users out of their devices or data until a ransom is paid to regain access.
- **Unsecured Wi-Fi networks:** Utilising public or unsecured Wi-Fi connections can leave mobile devices vulnerable to interception and data theft by unauthorised parties.
- **App-based threats:** Threats arising from malicious or compromised applications installed on mobile devices, which can exploit both personal and corporate data.
- **Jailbreaking or rootkit risks:** Altering a device's operating system through jailbreaking or rootkit installation can remove essential security features, heightening its susceptibility to various cyberattacks.

Essential Elements of Mobile Threat Defense

Securing our mobile devices involves a combination of crucial components, collectively known as Mobile Threat Defense (MTD). MTD comprises various elements designed to address different facets of mobile security effectively.

- **Real-time threat detection:** One fundamental aspect of MTD is real-time threat detection. MTD continuously monitors devices for any signs of malicious activity, promptly responding to any suspicious behaviour detected. This aspect emphasises the importance of identifying threats as they occur, ensuring swift action to mitigate potential risks.
- **Automated response and remediation:** Another critical component is automated response and remediation. Upon detecting a threat, MTD tools not only alert users or IT teams but also initiate automated actions to contain and neutralise the threat. This automation is particularly valuable in large organisations where manual responses to every alert are impractical.
- **Comprehensive visibility and control:** A robust MTD approach should offer organisations comprehensive visibility and control over their mobile devices. This entails having a clear understanding of all activities occurring on mobile devices and the capability to manage them efficiently. This component provides insights into a device's security status, including installed applications and usage patterns. Additionally, MTD should enable organisations to enforce security policies remotely.

Telangana State Cyber Security Bureau Warns of Lucky Draw Scams

The Telangana State Cyber Security Bureau has warned citizens against a rise in fraudulent activities wherein people are being victimised with promises of rewards through lucky draw schemes. Nearly 15 such cases were registered in Telangana in January alone, of which, majority are in the city.

In a recent case that has come to light, a woman who bought a saree online got a WhatsApp message 15 days later informing her that she has won a car in a lucky draw. She later found that she had been duped and lodged a complaint.

According to investigators, fraudsters are extorting lakhs of rupees through phony lucky draw schemes and scratch cards. The fraudsters convince unsuspecting individuals of winning lucky draws promising cash, car and vacations in foreign countries. The victim is asked to share personal data like bank card details or other information or scan some QR code sent on WhatsApp to claim their reward. As soon as the information is provided, the victim ends up losing money, officials said.

Sometimes, when a victim says that he is not interested in the car then an equivalent amount of cash is offered to him. Even fake letters are directly sent to the victim's home address, officials said.

An official of the Telangana State Cyber Security Bureau asked people to beware of calls and messages informing them of phony lucky draw prizes. The first step to prevent getting trapped is to be vigilant, said the official adding, "One should always exercise caution and report the crime by registering a complaint at the cybercrime cell."

Officials said that reputed e-commerce companies never send OTPs or scratch cards or unknown gift offers. "Don't click any link that is sent to you for claiming an award. If someone asks for a token amount to claim any award then it should be identified as a fraud. Shop only on official websites and don't be fooled by links and offers posted on social media platforms," an official said.

Karnataka Govt inks MoU with Truecaller for cyber security

The Karnataka government on Monday signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with Truecaller, the caller Id and spam blocking app, to enhance cyber safety awareness and promote safety in digital communication in the State. The collaboration aims to help citizens operate

from safe digital spaces and educate citizens on digital hygiene practices.

The comprehensive campaign will improve online safety awareness with practical tips that will stop citizens from falling prey to scams. It will also enable them to safeguard their personal information and use digital communication tools responsibly.

Priyank Kharge, Minister for Rural Development and Panchayat Raj and ITBT said, "This partnership underscores the government's commitment to prioritizing the safety of our citizens in the digital ecosystem." He added that the government is taking proactive steps to increase awareness and promote safety in digital communications.

Rishit Jhunjhunwala, Chief Product Officer and MD Truecaller India, said "We are delighted to collaborate with the government to enhance digital safety, empowering citizens to make the most of opportunities available to them in the digital world. At Truecaller, we are working towards preventing fraud cases and are confident that this collaboration will assist citizens of Karnataka in staying one step ahead of fraudsters."

Bengaluru techie loses Rs 96 lakh in stock market fraud, FIR registered

In yet another case of cybercrime in the city, a techie in Kothanur has lost Rs 96 lakh after the accused lured him to join a Telegram group in the name of giving him stock market advice. The victim was asked to download an application in which he gave his bank details and PAN. Within 75 days, the victim invested over Rs 96 lakh and when he failed to get any profit in return he got suspicious and filed a police complaint.

The victim Ayyappa in November last year came across a message on his mobile phone in which he was offered tips to invest in the stock market.

When he clicked on the link in the message, he was directed to the Telegram group 'Elite Team 18.' The victim met a woman Anna Chatterjee. She asked him to download an application and give details of his bank account and PAN card number.

After providing all the details, the accused was introduced to a website which looked like any trading platform. The other accused in the group kept posting fake success stories of huge profits in a short time. The victim fell into the fraud and started investing money. He was also forced to transfer money to different bank accounts as a brokerage. After over two months, the victim got suspicious as he did not receive any profit from his investment.

After the accused started forcing him to invest more money, the victim approached

the NorthEast Cyber, Economic and Narcotics (CEN) Crime Police Station.

A case has been registered under Information Technology Act 66(D) (any communication device or computer resource cheats by personation) and IPC sections 419 (punishment for cheating), 420 (cheating and dishonestly inducing delivery of property)

Delhi Police Nabs Mastermind of Rs 58 Lakh Virtual Credit Card Scam

In a significant breakthrough, the Delhi Police Cyber Cell has nabbed 26-year-old Ramandeep Singh, the mastermind behind a massive virtual credit card scam carried out using the KIWI app. The sophisticated operation, which resulted in a loss of Rs 58 lakh, involved the creation of virtual credit cards using stolen Permanent Account Number (PAN) details, linked to multiple mobile numbers and Gmail accounts.

A Raid and Confession

The arrest followed a complaint lodged by Surinder Singh, a resident of Vasant Kunj, Delhi, which led to a subsequent raid in Fazilka, Punjab. During the raid, the authorities seized six smartphones, 121 SIM cards, identification documents, ATM cards, and a laptop. In the ensuing interrogation, Ramandeep Singh confessed to his role in the fraudulent scheme.

Understanding Virtual Credit Card Scams

The modus operandi of virtual credit card scams typically involves the creation of unauthorized virtual cards. Fraudsters obtain sensitive personal information, link the illegitimate cards to numerous accounts, and exploit the credit limits for illicit transactions. The common variants include phishing, fake card services, unauthorized card creation, account takeover, tech support scams, application-based scams, social engineering, online purchase scams, account hacking, sim-swapping attacks, and malware or keylogging.

Preventing Virtual Credit Card Frauds

Individuals can protect themselves from falling prey to such scams by implementing several measures. These include securing personal information, using reputable platforms, regularly monitoring accounts, being cautious of phishing attempts, enabling two-factor authentication, updating and securing devices, regularly checking credit reports, educating themselves about various scams, using secure Wi-Fi networks, and reporting any suspicious activities without delay.

बैंक KYC के नाम पर चल रहा है धोखाधड़ी का खेल, RBI ने बताया बचने का शानदार तरीका

आज दुनिया हाईटेक होती जा रही है, ऐसे में साइबर क्राइम भी जबरदस्त तेजी से बढ़ रहा है। ऐसे में ऑनलाइन अपराध करने वाले लोग कई नए-नए इस्तेमाल करते रहते हैं। फिलहाल बैंक केवाईसी के नाम पर धोखाधड़ी के मामले काफी ज्यादा बढ़ गए हैं। यही कारण है कि इस पर रिजर्व बैंक आफ इंडिया ने भी चिंता जताई है। रिजर्व बैंक ऑफ इंडिया लगातार लोगों को केवाईसी अपडेट करने के नाम पर होने वाले फ्रॉड से जागरूक रहने की बात कहता रहा है।

फिलहाल ऐसी घटनाओं में एक बार फिर तेजी देखने को मिल रही है यही कारण है कि रिजर्व बैंक ऑफ़ इंडिया ने लोगों को सतर्क रहने का निर्देश दिया है। आपकी जानकारी के लिए बता दें कि रिजर्व बैंक ऑफ इंडिया के द्वारा इस तरह के धोखाधड़ी वाले मामले से बचने के लिए काफी जानकारी दी गई है। जिसके बारे में हम आपको इस आर्टिकल में बताने जा रहे हैं।

आपकी जानकारी के लिए बता दे की केवाईसी के नाम पर धोखाधड़ी आपसे किसी भी माध्यम से की जा सकती है। ऐसे मामले में अक्सर इस स्कैमर्स के द्वारा कोई फोन कॉल की जाती है, कोई मैसेज आता है या फिर ईमेल किया जाता है।

इन ईमेल में स्कैनर अपने आप को बैंक का कर्मचारी बताते हैं और आपसे आपकी पर्सनल डिटेल मांगते हैं ताकि आपकी केवाईसी को अपडेट किया जा सके। कई बार लोग इनके झांसे में आ जाते हैं और अपनी जरूरी जानकारी दे देते हैं, जिससे आपके साथ फ्रॉड हो सकता है। इसके अलावा कई मामले तो ऐसे भी हैं जिनमें आपको कुछ एप्लीकेशन डाउनलोड करने को कहा जाता है, इन एप्लीकेशन में आपके मोबाइल की परमिशन का एक्सेस होता है और अगर आपने इन्हें इंस्टॉल कर लिया तो आपकी पूरी जानकारी बैंक डिटेल समेत स्कैमर्स के पास पहुंच जाती है, जहां से ये आपके पैसे आसानी से उड़ा देते हैं। यही कारण है कि आपके बिना जाने समझे कोई भी अनाधिकृत और बिना वेरीफाई किया हुआ एप्लीकेशन नहीं इंस्टॉल करना चाहिए। गौरतलब है कि कई बार इन स्कैमर के द्वारा यह भी कहा जाता है कि आपका अकाउंट बंद कर दिया जाएगा, ऐसी कंडीशन में आपको उनकी कॉल तुरंत काट देनी चाहिए और बैंक के अधिकृत टोल फ्री नंबर पर कॉल करके इस बात की पुष्टि करनी चाहिए।

ऐसे स्कैम से बचने के लिए आप कई तरीके इस्तेमाल कर सकते हैं। रिजर्व बैंक आफ इंडिया ने इसके लिए कुछ आसान और बेहद प्रभावित तरीकों के बारे में बताया है। अगर आपको केवाईसी अपडेशन के लिए कोई रिक्वेस्ट आती है तो आप सीधे बैंक से संपर्क करके इस बात की जानकारी ले सकते हैं। आपके साथ कोई भी साइबर फ्रॉड होता है तो आप इसकी जानकारी तुरंत अपने बैंक को दें और पुलिस में भी कंप्लेंट करें। आप साइबर सेल में ऑनलाइन कंप्लेंट भी फाइल कर सकते हैं। अगर आपके साथ कोई

साइबर क्राइम हो जाता है तो आप 1930 टोल फ्री नंबर पर कॉल करके शिकायत दर्ज कर सकते हैं। इसके अलावा www.cybercrime.gov.in पर भी ऐसे अपराधों के खिलाफ शिकायत कर सकते हैं। इसके अलावा अगर आपको किसी अनजान नंबर से कॉल आ रहा है तो उसे बैंक की अधिकृत टोल फ्री नंबर या वेबसाइट पर जाकर उसके नंबर से मैच कर लें, अगर वह नंबर सेम नहीं है तो किसी भी तरह की जानकारी न दें। आपको बता दें कि अगर कोई भी व्यक्ति केवाईसी के लिए आपके नंबर पर आए ओटीपी या पासवर्ड की मांग करता है तो वह कभी न शेयर करें। आपको किसी भी तरह की अनजान एप्लीकेशन को डाउनलोड करने से भी बचना चाहिए। इसके अलावा केवाईसी अपडेशन के नाम पर कई बार आपको कुछ लिंक भेजी जाती है, तो उन्हें इग्नोर करें और उन पर कभी क्लिक न करें। जरा सभी संदेह होने पर तुरंत बैंक से संपर्क करें।

International

Schneider Electric Confirms Data Leak From a Ransomware Attack

Schneider Electric has suffered a ransomware attack affecting its Sustainability Business division-specific systems, including the Resource Advisory system, a data visualization tool serving over 2,000 companies.

The division offers consultancy services on renewable energy solutions and assists clients in complying with climate regulatory requirements.

Employing over 150,000 people worldwide, Schneider boasts of assisting "40% of the Fortune 500 companies" to reduce emissions and aims to eliminate "800 million tons of CO2 emissions by 2025."

Meanwhile, the French multinational energy and automation company said the Jan 17 ransomware attack was limited to its Sustainability Business division.

"Sustainability Business is an autonomous entity operating its isolated network infrastructure, no other entity within the Schneider Electric group has been affected," said Schneider Electric.

Schneider Electric responds to a ransomware attack

Schneider said it mobilized its Global Incident Response team to contain the ransomware attack and reinforce existing security measures.

It also hired an external cybersecurity firm to investigate the ransomware attack and was working with relevant authorities. Schneider plans to take additional actions based on the outcome of the inquiry.

The company is also working to restore business systems in a secure environment with the expectation that access will resume in the next two business days. On average, the downtime resulting from a ransomware attack lasts 24 days.

A status update on Schneider's website stated that the company reopened the Sustainability Business division's business systems on January 31, 2024.

Schneider Electric ransomware attack leaked data

Schneider has confirmed that data was accessed during the ransomware attack and had notified the impacted customers.

"From an impact assessment standpoint, the on-going investigation shows that data have been accessed," said Schneider Electric.

However, the nature of the stolen data remains undisclosed. It could include corporate information, such as energy utilization, regulatory compliance, and automation data. Energy companies also collect and store personal and financial information.

"While purely speculation at this time, the timing of the attack is curious as it is just days before the company releases its annual financial results," said Yossi Rachman, senior director of research at Semperis. "And often ransomware attacks become material events quickly when data is stolen. And in the case of Schneider, we are talking about terabytes of data."

Schneider has promised "to continue the dialogue directly with its impacted customers" and "continue to provide information and assistance as relevant."

Schneider's cyber attack is linked to the Cactus ransomware gang

The Schneider Electric ransomware attack was attributed to the Cactus ransomware group, which has threatened to leak terabytes of stolen data unless the company pays an undisclosed ransom.

Schneider has not confirmed Cactus ransomware's involvement, and the energy and automation company's name has not appeared on the group's dark web data leak site.

"The connection of the Schneider Electric attack to the Cactus ransomware group likely arises from two factors: Cactus' history of targeting corporate networks and potential Qlik software use within Schneider Electric," said Sarah Jones, Cyber Threat Intelligence Research Analyst at Critical Start. "Since Cactus previously exploited vulnerabilities in Qlik software, it further strengthens the Cactus connection."

Since March 2023, when it began operations, the Cactus ransomware gang has allegedly victimized at least 88 businesses, including Groupe Promotrans, Seymours, Marfrig Global Foods, MINEMAN Systems, and Maxxd Trailers

"Naturally, with high-profile customers including Hilton and PepsiCo, Schneider Electric fits the bill," said Darren Williams, CEO and Founder of BlackFog.

The group exploits virtual private networks (VPN) appliances for initial access and deploys SSH backdoors for persistence. Microsoft threat intelligence also warned it observed the cyber gang using online advertisements to target its victims. However, the attack vector exploited during the attack remains undisclosed.

In the past, Schneider Electric has suffered cyber-attacks, being one of the victims of the Clop ransomware gang's MOVEit data breach that affected thousands of companies.

The energy sector, part of the critical infrastructure, is a desirable target due to the

widespread impacts that disruption could cause.

"This Cactus ransomware attack on Schneider Electric joins the recent uptick of critical national infrastructure (CNI) attacks," Williams concluded. "In particular, the energy sector is a prime target due to its potentially lucrative rewards, if successful, and the maximum chaos caused by its widespread public reach."

HPE is investigating claims of a new security breach

The announcement was published on BreachForums by a threat actor who uses the moniker IntelBroker.

"Hello BreachForums Community. Today, I am selling the data I have taken from Hewlett Packard Enterprise." reads the announcement published by IntelBroker. "More specifically, the data includes: CI/CD access , System logs , Config Files , Access Tokens , HPE StoreOnce Files (Serial numbers warrant etc) & Access passwords. (Email services are also included)"

The announcement also published some screenshots containing allegedly stolen HPE credentials.

Recently Hewlett Packard Enterprise (HPE) revealed that alleged Russia-linked cyberespionage group Midnight Blizzard gained access to its Microsoft Office 365 cloud-based email environment.

The attackers were collecting information on the cybersecurity division of the company and other functions.

HPE became aware of the intrusion on December 2023 and immediately launched an investigation into the security breach with the help of external cybersecurity experts.

The investigation revealed that the attackers gained access to the company environment and exfiltrated data since May 2023. The cyberspies compromised a small percentage of HPE mailboxes belonging to individuals in our cybersecurity, go-to-market, business segments, and other functions.

"On December 12, 2023, Hewlett Packard Enterprise Company (the "Company," "HPE," or "we") was notified that a suspected nation-state actor, believed to be the threat actor Midnight Blizzard, the state-sponsored actor also known as Cozy Bear, had gained unauthorized access to HPE's cloud-based email environment. The Company, with assistance from external cybersecurity experts, immediately activated our response process to investigate, contain, and remediate the incident, eradicating the activity." reads FORM8-K filing with the U.S. Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC). "Based on our investigation, we now believe that the threat actor accessed and exfiltrated data beginning in May 2023 from a small percentage of HPE mailboxes belonging to individuals in our

cybersecurity, go-to-market, business segments, and other functions."

The investigation is still ongoing, however, the IT giant determined that the intrusion is likely linked to another attack conducted by the same APT group, of which they were notified in June 2023.

News / Feeds References

National

1. https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/32-lakh-sim-cards-involved-in-frauds-blocked-by-govt/article67818663.ece
2. https://www.news18.com/india/soon-you-can-check-if-a-mobile-number-or-upi-id-is-involved-in-cyber-frauds-database-in-the-works-by-mhas-i4c-8767831.html
3. https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/tamil-nadu/scamsters-are-increasingly-creating-fake-profiles-of-government-officials-well-known-figures-to-target-public-tn-police/article67817263.ece
4. https://timesofindia.indiatimes.com/gadgets-news/what-is-mobile-threat-defense-know-how-to-protect-your-mobile-from-cyber-threats/articleshow/107454446.cms
5. https://www.etvbharat.com/en/!state/telangana-state-cyber-security-bureau-warns-of-lucky-draw-scams-enn24020602235
6. https://www.newindianexpress.com/states/karnataka/2024/Feb/06/karnataka-govt-inks-mou-with-truecaller-for-cyber-security
7. https://www.news9live.com/city/bengaluru/bengaluru-techie-loses-rs-96-lakh-in-stock-market-fraud-fir-registered-2429850
8. https://bnnbreaking.com/tech/cybersecurity/delhi-police-nabs-mastermind-of-rs-58-lakh-virtual-credit-card-scam/
9. https://hindi.goodreturns.in/personal-finance/rbi-on-bank-kyc-update-frauds-gives-set-of-guidelines-to-stay-protected-against-cyber-crime-042079.html?story=3

International

1. https://www.cpomagazine.com/cyber-security/schneider-electric-confirms-data-leak-from-a-ransomware-attack/
2. https://securityaffairs.com/158690/cyber-crime/hpe-investigating-security-breach.html

IF YOU ARE A VICTIM OF "ONLNE FINANCIAL FRAUD" IMMEDIATELY CALL ON HELPLINE NUMBER 1930

REGISTER YOUR COMPLAINT AT

HTTPS://WWW.CYBERCRIME.GOV.IN

FOLLOW US ON

CYBER DOST